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The Tale of Custard The Dragon

-Ogden Nash

I Reference to Context:

1 "Now the ---------- the custard."

a What are the names of the little black kitten and little grey mouse?

ans The names of the little black kitten and little grey mouse were Ink and Blink.

b Belinda named the dragon Custard because he was very Brave. True or False.

ans False

c Which of the following statements is incorrect:

(i) The dog's name was Blink (✓)

(ii) The mouse was grey

(iii) Custard was a dragon

(iv) The kitten's name was ink

d Name the poetic device used in the third line of extract.

ans Simily.

II Answer the following Short Answers:

Q1 Who is Belinda? Name her pet animals.

ans Belinda is a brave little girl who lives in a cozy house with her unique pets. Her animal companions include a kitten named Ink, a grey mouse called Blink, a dog named Mustard, and a cowardly dragon named Custard. Despite Custard's timid nature, he proves to be the bravest of them all.

Q2 Why did Belinda and her pets laugh at the dragon?

ans Belinda and her pets laughed at Custard the dragon because he always acted scared and cried for a safe cage, unlike the others who boasted about their bravery. They found his cowardice amusing and mocked him, thinking he was the weakest among them. Ironically, Custard later proved to be the true hero.

Q3 What made Belinda cry for help? How did her pets respond in that situation?

ans Belinda cried for help when a fierce pirate entered her house with pistols and a cutlass. Her brave pets - Ink, Blink and Mustard - ran away in fear, despite their earlier boasts. Only Custard the dragon, usually timid, sprang into action and bravely fought the pirate, saving everyone.

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III Answer the following Long Answers:

Q1 Do not judge a book by its cover prove it by giving details in context of the fanciful story poem 'The Tale of Custard The Dragon'.

ans The poem 'The Tale of Custard the Dragon' by Ogden Nash humorously illustrates the saying "Don't judge a book by its cover". Belinda and her pets - Ink, Blink, and Mustard - boast of their bravery, while Custard the dragon is mocked for bieng cowardly. His constant plea for a cage makes others laugh at him, assuming he lacks courage.

However, when a pirate suddenly attacks their home, the so-called brave pets panic and flee. Belinda cries for help, and suprisingly, Custard - who was always rediculed - rises to the occasion. He fearlessly fights the pirate, swallowing him and saving everyone. This unexpected act of bravery shocks the others.

Custard's actions prove that appearances and reputations can be misleading. True courage lies in action, not in words. The poem teaches us to value substance over show.